

# Work & Careers

78 words · Work & Careers

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## NOUNS

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### job

a paid position of regular employment  
*She's been looking for a job since finishing university.*

### salary

a fixed regular payment for employment, usually monthly  
*His salary doubled when he moved to the private sector.*

### colleague

a person you work with  
*She gets on well with all her colleagues.*

### employer

a person or organisation that employs people  
*Your employer is legally required to provide a safe working environment.*

### contract

a formal agreement between employer and employee  
*Always read your contract carefully before signing.*

### deadline

the latest time by which something must be completed  
*The deadline is Friday. There's no time to waste.*

### shift

a set period of time worked, especially with rotating hours  
*She works the night shift three times a week.*

### redundancy

the state of being made unemployed because the job is no longer needed  
*He was offered voluntary redundancy after the restructure.*

### work

activity involving mental or physical effort done to earn money  
*How's work going? Busy, but I'm enjoying it.*

### boss

a person's manager or employer  
*My boss asked me to stay late to finish the report.*

### employee

a person who works for someone else in exchange for payment  
*The company has over two hundred employees.*

### career

the series of jobs a person has over their working life  
*She's built an impressive career in finance over twenty years.*

### interview

a formal meeting to assess a candidate for a job  
*He was nervous before the interview but it went well.*

### promotion

advancement to a higher position or rank  
*She was offered a promotion after just two years.*

### workload

the amount of work a person is expected to do  
*Her workload has increased significantly since the merger.*

### appraisal

a formal assessment of an employee's performance  
*Her annual appraisal highlighted strengths and areas for improvement.*

**incentive**

something that motivates someone to work harder

*A performance bonus is a powerful incentive for staff.*

**sabbatical**

a period of paid leave for professional development or research

*She took a six-month sabbatical to write her book.*

**deep work**

a period of focused, distraction-free effort on a cognitively demanding task

*She blocks out two hours of deep work every morning before checking email.*

**vacancy**

a job or position that is available and needs to be filled

*There are two vacancies in the marketing department.*

**hustle culture**

the glorification of constant work and side projects as a lifestyle

*She rejected hustle culture and prioritised rest and balance instead.*

**ADJECTIVES**

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**employed**

having a paid job

*She's been fully employed since graduating three years ago.*

**full-time**

working or involving the standard number of hours per week

*She's looking for a full-time position in marketing.*

**rewarding**

providing personal satisfaction or a sense of accomplishment

*She finds working with children deeply rewarding.*

**motivated**

having a strong desire to do or achieve something

*She's highly motivated and rarely needs to be chased for work.*

**demanding**

requiring a lot of skill, time, or effort

*Teaching can be one of the most demanding jobs there is.*

**indispensable**

absolutely necessary; too valuable to do without

*A good PA can make themselves indispensable within weeks.*

**conscientious**

taking great care to do work thoroughly and correctly

*She is conscientious, always double-checking her reports.*

**unemployed**

without a paid job; out of work

*He's been unemployed for six months and is actively looking.*

**part-time**

working fewer hours than the standard working week

*He works part-time while studying for his degree.*

**self-employed**

working for oneself rather than for an employer

*As a freelancer, he has been self-employed for five years.*

**sorted**

dealt with, resolved, very common in informal British English

*Did you manage to get it sorted?*

**full-on**

very busy or intense, informal and common in British English

*Yeah, it's just been full-on lately. I'm hoping things calm down next month.*

**lucrative**

producing a great deal of profit or financial gain

*Investment banking is notoriously lucrative but stressful.*

## VERBS

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### **apply**

to formally request to be considered for a job  
*I applied for three jobs this week.*

### **fire**

to dismiss someone from their job  
*He was fired for repeatedly missing deadlines.*

### **retire**

to stop working permanently, usually at a certain age  
*He plans to retire at sixty-five.*

### **delegate**

to assign a task to someone else, usually a subordinate  
*Good managers know when to delegate.*

### **resign**

to formally and voluntarily leave a job or position  
*She decided to resign after a disagreement with the board.*

### **headhunt**

to approach someone employed elsewhere and offer them a job  
*He was headhunted by a tech company offering twice his salary.*

### **hire**

to employ someone for a job  
*They're hiring ten new staff for the summer.*

### **quit**

to leave a job, often without much notice  
*She quit her job and went travelling for a year.*

### **commute**

to travel regularly between home and work  
*She commutes two hours each way by train.*

### **collaborate**

to work jointly with others on a project or task  
*The two departments collaborated closely on the product launch.*

### **outsource**

to hire an external company to do work rather than doing it in-house  
*Many firms outsource their customer service to reduce costs.*

### **micromanage**

to control every small detail of a team's work  
*Staff morale suffered because the director tended to micromanage.*

## PHRASAL VERBS

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### **take on**

to accept new work or employ new staff  
*The company decided to take on twenty new apprentices.*

### **follow up**

to contact someone again about something already discussed, or to check on its progress  
*I'll follow up with the supplier if we haven't heard anything by Wednesday.*

### **lay off**

to dismiss employees because of lack of work  
*The factory laid off two hundred workers due to falling demand.*

### **push back**

to delay something to a later time  
*Can we push the Tuesday call back to Thursday?*

### **hand in**

to formally submit something, such as a resignation  
*She handed in her notice after ten years at the firm.*

### **burn out**

to become exhausted through sustained overwork  
*He burned out after working eighteen-hour days for two years.*

### **circle back**

to return to a topic, task, or person at a later point  
*Let's circle back to the budget once we've heard from finance.*

### **slack off**

to start working less hard or to become lazy  
*People tend to slack off on Fridays, especially in the summer.*

### **knock off**

to stop working, especially at the end of the day (informal)

*What time do you knock off? Usually around six.*

## **COLLOCATIONS**

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### **work from home**

to do your job from your house rather than going to an office

*She works from home two days a week.*

### **a step up**

a move to a higher-level position

*It's a step up from what I'm doing now, which is exciting but a bit daunting.*

### **climb the career ladder**

to progress to higher positions in one's career

*He worked hard to climb the career ladder in a competitive industry.*

### **block out time**

to reserve a period in your schedule for a specific task

*I should manage, I've already blocked out time this afternoon.*

### **flexible hours**

a work arrangement that lets employees choose when they start and finish, within limits

*The company offers flexible hours, so I usually start at seven and finish early.*

### **meet a deadline**

to complete work by the required date

*She always meets her deadlines, even under pressure.*

### **in the loop**

kept informed about something

*Just keep me in the loop if the numbers change.*

### **work your way up**

to advance from a low position through effort

*He worked his way up from intern to managing director.*

## **IDIOMS**

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### **get the sack**

to be dismissed from a job (informal)

*He got the sack after arriving late for the third time.*

### **pull your weight**

to do your fair share of the work in a team or group

*If everyone pulled their weight, the project would be finished by now.*

### **snowed under**

overwhelmed with a large amount of work

*I can't take on anything new right now, I'm completely snowed under.*

### **a safe pair of hands**

a reliable person who can be trusted to handle things well

*They appointed her because she was seen as a safe pair of hands.*

### **have a lot on your plate**

to be dealing with many tasks or responsibilities at once

*I'd love to help with the presentation, but I've got a lot on my plate this month.*

### **hit the ground running**

to begin a new job with great energy and preparation

*The new recruit hit the ground running from day one.*

### **carry the can**

to take the blame for something, often unfairly

*When the project failed, it was the junior staff who carried the can.*

### **in the pipeline**

being planned or developed but not yet complete

*A new performance review system is in the pipeline.*

## SET PHRASES

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### no worries if not

a friendly way to show you won't mind if a request is declined

*Could you send the report over by lunchtime? No worries if not, tomorrow morning's fine too.*

### I am responsible for

a formal way to describe your job duties, less natural in conversation than 'I deal with'

*I deal with customer complaints mostly, rather than saying I am responsible for them.*

### touch base

to make brief contact with someone to check in or exchange updates

*Let's touch base on Monday morning before the client call.*

### could do with

would really benefit from, common in British English

*Not yet, but I could really do with a break. It's been a long year.*

## MODERN SLANG

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### quiet quitting

doing only the minimum required without formally leaving

*Half the team seemed to be quiet quitting after the restructure.*

### grind culture

the glorification of overworking as a badge of honour

*She's pushed back hard against grind culture since burning out.*

### side hustle

a small job or business you run alongside your main employment to earn extra money

*She designs wedding invitations as a side hustle at weekends.*